

History of English Literature - Important MCQs (Part 29)

Page 142 - Historians of the Period

Q1. David Hume is better known as a...

- A. Sceptical philosopher
- B. Romantic poet
- C. Radical politician
- D. Playwright

Answer: A

Q2. What major historical work did David Hume write?

- A. History of the Roman Empire
- B. History of England
- C. History of Scotland
- D. History of America

Answer: B

Q3. Hume's History of England is greatly marred by carelessness and strong bias in favor of the...

- A. Puritans
- B. Stuarts
- C. Hanoverians
- D. Tudors

Answer: B

Q4. Following the lead of Voltaire, Hume combined his political narrative with information concerning...

- A. Science and nature
- B. Civilisation and manners
- C. Religion and theology
- D. Geography and trade

Answer: B

Q5. William Robertson wrote a History of Scotland, a History of America, and a History of...

- A. The Renaissance
- B. Charles V

History of English Literature - Important MCQs (Part 29)

- C. The Middle Ages
- D. The French Revolution

Answer: B

Q6. Who was incomparably the greatest historian of the time?

- A. David Hume
- B. Edward Gibbon
- C. William Robertson
- D. Edmund Burke

Answer: B

Q7. What is Edward Gibbon's acknowledged masterpiece?

- A. The Decline and Fall of the Roman Empire
- B. History of England
- C. The French Revolution
- D. Rights of Man

Answer: A

Q8. The idea of writing the decline and fall of Rome first started in Gibbon's mind while he sat musing amongst the ruins of the...

- A. Colosseum
- B. Capitol
- C. Pantheon
- D. Forum

Answer: B

Q9. Gibbon's record begins with the reign of Titus (AD 98) and closes with the capture of Constantinople by the Turks in...

- A. 1066
- B. 1215
- C. 1453
- D. 1588

Answer: C

History of English Literature - Important MCQs (Part 29)

Q10. The late E. A. Freeman noted that modern research has not set Gibbon aside. Which of the following is a fault found with him?

- A. He lacks historical accuracy
- B. He deals inadequately with religious aspects
- C. He fails to research enough
- D. His timeline is confused

Answer: B

History of English Literature - Important MCQs (Part 29)

Page 143 - Political Prose: Burke, Paine, Godwin

Q1. Who is the great name in the political prose of the period?

- A. David Hume
- B. Edward Gibbon
- C. Edmund Burke
- D. Horace Walpole

Answer: C

Q2. Burke carried passionate moral earnestness and splendid logical powers into political controversy. His principles were those of...

- A. Radicalism
- B. Philosophic conservatism
- C. Socialism
- D. Utilitarianism

Answer: B

Q3. Which cause did Burke support in his speeches in 1774 and 1775?

- A. The French Revolution
- B. The American colonies
- C. The abolition of slavery
- D. The East India Company

Answer: B

Q4. In 'Reflections' (1790), what did Burke bitterly oppose?

- A. The American Revolution
- B. The French Revolution
- C. The Spanish Inquisition
- D. The monarchy

Answer: B

Q5. Who answered Burke's 'Reflections' with 'Rights of Man'?

- A. William Godwin

History of English Literature - Important MCQs (Part 29)

- B. Thomas Paine
- C. Jean-Jacques Rousseau
- D. David Hume

Answer: B

Q6. Which work is considered the first important English treatise on aesthetics by Burke?

- A. Rights of Man
- B. Inquiry into the Origin of our Ideas of the Sublime and Beautiful
- C. Thoughts on the Present Discontents
- D. Letter to a Noble Lord

Answer: B

Q7. Who is generally attributed as the author of the seventy letters filled with fierce invective under the signature 'Junius'?

- A. Edmund Burke
- B. Thomas Paine
- C. Sir Philip Francis
- D. Horace Walpole

Answer: C

Q8. Who was the most conspicuous philosophical supporter of the French Revolution in England?

- A. Edmund Burke
- B. William Godwin
- C. Lord Chesterfield
- D. Thomas Gray

Answer: B

Q9. What did William Godwin write?

- A. Inquiry concerning Political Justice
- B. Letters on a Regicide Peace
- C. The Rights of Man
- D. Thoughts on the Present Discontents

Answer: A

History of English Literature - Important MCQs (Part 29)

Q10. The letters of Chesterfield, addressed to his son, were intended as a manual in...

- A. Political strategy
- B. Polite behaviour
- C. Military tactics
- D. Business management

Answer: B

History of English Literature - Important MCQs (Part 29)

Page 144 - Letter Writers and Walpole

Q1. Horace Walpole's letters are described as a lively chronicle of social doings, small talk, and...

- A. Deep philosophy
- B. Scandals
- C. Religious debates
- D. Economic theory

Answer: B

Q2. In what kind of circles did Horace Walpole play his part?

- A. Revolutionary factions
- B. Working class unions
- C. Charmed circles of dilettante triflers
- D. Academic institutions

Answer: C

Q3. What gives a rather poor impression of Walpole's character according to the text?

- A. His profound sadness
- B. His flippancy and frequent spitefulness
- C. His extreme conservatism
- D. His religious bigotry

Answer: B

Q4. According to Footnote 1, where was Rousseau born?

- A. Paris
- B. London
- C. Geneva
- D. Rome

Answer: C

Q5. Despite his birthplace, among which country's writers is Rousseau always classed?

- A. English writers
- B. Swiss writers

History of English Literature - Important MCQs (Part 29)

- C. French writers
- D. German writers

Answer: C

Q6. Walpole's letters are described as having a triviality of...

- A. Purpose
- B. Style
- C. Length
- D. Morals

Answer: B

Q7. Which author's name is mentioned to come up again in connection with the novel?

- A. Lord Chesterfield
- B. Horace Walpole
- C. Edmund Burke
- D. Sir Philip Francis

Answer: B

Q8. The letter writers cultivated their work both as a pastime and as an...

- A. Art
- B. Expense
- C. Obligation
- D. Educational tool

Answer: A

Q9. Lady Mary Wortley Montagu's letters are particularly interesting when dealing with her varied experiences...

- A. In the countryside
- B. Abroad
- C. In the royal court
- D. During the war

Answer: B

History of English Literature - Important MCQs (Part 29)

Q10. Chesterfield's tone in his letters is that of a typical...

- A. Preacher
- B. Romantic poet
- C. Man of the world
- D. Philosopher

Answer: C

History of English Literature - Important MCQs (Part 29)

Page 145 - The Novel before Richardson

Q1. The firm establishment and assured popularity of the novel dates from the age of...

- A. Dryden
- B. Pope
- C. Johnson
- D. Wordsworth

Answer: C

Q2. The establishment of the novel may be accounted the greatest achievement of the...

- A. Romantic Age
- B. Age of Johnson
- C. Elizabethan Age
- D. Victorian Age

Answer: B

Q3. It may be fairly contended that prose fiction passed definitely into its modern form with...

- A. Defoe
- B. Swift
- C. Richardson
- D. Fielding

Answer: C

Q4. Most of the prose fiction produced during the age of Shakespeare was purely...

- A. Realistic
- B. Romantic or didactic
- C. Satirical
- D. Historical

Answer: B

Q5. Which of the following writers produced purely romantic fiction during Shakespeare's age?

- A. Sidney, Lodge, and Greene
- B. More, Lyly, and Bacon

History of English Literature - Important MCQs (Part 29)

C. Nash and Marlowe

D. Defoe and Swift

Answer: A

Q6. A slight tendency to realism was shown in the picaresque work of...

A. Sidney

B. Greene

C. Nash

D. Lyly

Answer: C

Q7. What long-winded form of romance was imported from France?

A. Gothic Romance

B. Historical Romance

C. Heroic Romance

D. Pastoral Romance

Answer: C

Q8. The Heroic Romance was a strange compound of sham chivalry, pseudo-history, and sham...

A. Religion

B. Pastoralism

C. Philosophy

D. Science

Answer: B

Q9. The Heroic Romance enjoyed a temporary vogue on...

A. Italian soil

B. English soil

C. German soil

D. Spanish soil

Answer: B

Q10. The Heroic Romance reflected the extravagant gallantry of a...

History of English Literature - Important MCQs (Part 29)

- A. Primitive society
- B. Sophisticated society
- C. Rural society
- D. Monastic society

Answer: B

History of English Literature - Important MCQs (Part 29)

Page 146 - The Transformation of Prose Fiction

Q1. In reaction against the prolixity and unreality of Heroic Romance, who began to cultivate a form of story marked by brevity?

- A. Jane Austen
- B. Aphra Behn
- C. Frances Burney
- D. George Eliot

Answer: B

Q2. Aphra Behn and several other women-writers showed a desire to get back to...

- A. Truth and nature
- B. Myth and legend
- C. Classical ideals
- D. Strict formalism

Answer: A

Q3. What extraneous influence contributed to the transformation of prose fiction?

- A. The work of the Character-writers
- B. The decline of poetry
- C. The rise of science
- D. The industrial revolution

Answer: A

Q4. The work of Addison and Steele in the periodical essay was an important influence on the...

- A. Drama
- B. Epic
- C. Novel
- D. Lyric poetry

Answer: C

Q5. Whose marvellously effective use of fiction as allegory has to be recognized?

- A. Spenser's

History of English Literature - Important MCQs (Part 29)

- B. Bunyan's
- C. Milton's
- D. Chaucer's

Answer: B

Q6. What kind of narrative became increasingly popular, whose forms and methods could easily be carried over into fictitious narrative?

- A. History
- B. Biography
- C. Travelogue
- D. Diary

Answer: B

Q7. Who adopted the manner and tone of actual biography with studious preciseness?

- A. Swift
- B. Defoe
- C. Fielding
- D. Smollett

Answer: B

Q8. Why did Defoe just miss his way to creating the genuine novel?

- A. He lacked imagination
- B. His style was too difficult
- C. His tales deal so largely with strange adventure and crime
- D. He focused too much on romance

Answer: C

Q9. No one before Richardson had written a novel of contemporary social and domestic life where interest depended on...

- A. Epic battles
- B. Ordinary people in a familiar setting
- C. Magical realism
- D. Political intrigue

History of English Literature - Important MCQs (Part 29)

Answer: B

Q10. With what novel did Richardson produce a story of contemporary social and domestic life?

- A. Clarissa
- B. Pamela
- C. Tom Jones
- D. Robinson Crusoe

Answer: B